Inner Baby

By Eric Bogosian

INTRODUCTION

When we were 3 or 4 we couldn't look around us and say "Well, Dad ís a drunk and Mom is real depressed and scared - that is why it feels so awful here. I think I'll go get my own apartment" Our parents were our higher powers. We were not capable of understanding that they might have problems that had nothing to do with us. So it felt like it was our fault. We need to take responsibility without taking the blame. We need to own and honor the feelings without being a victim of them. We need to rescue and nurture and love our inner children - and STOP them from controlling our lives. STOP them from driving the bus! Children are not supposed to drive, they are not supposed to be in control. History has been, and is being, made by immature, scared, angry, hurt individuals who are reacting to their childhood wounds and programming - reacting to the little child inside who feels unworthy and unlovable.

That ends today with Eric Bogosian's Inner Baby . . .

Stride out onto the stage, arms stretched out, to applause. In a mild Southern accent.

Thank you! Thank you so much! I am so happy to see so many happy, smiling faces in this audience here tonight. I am turned on by the potential for change I feel in this room. I can feel it coming up out of the audience, into my legs, my body, my head. I am exploding with the power of change in this room tonight!

You know, I go all over this great country of ours, talking to audiences just like you, about change, about human potential. And everywhere I go, people ask me the same question, they say, "Phil. . . what is the secret of happiness? What is the secret of joy? Of ecstasy?"

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And everywhere I go, I tell people the same story. I tell them a story about a little boy who went into a candy store and all he had was a nickel. He went into that store and he picked out the candy bar he wanted more than any other.
And he said to the man behind the counter, "Sir, I would like that candy bar right there. Here is my nickel."
And the man looked down at the little boy and the little boy's nickel and he said, "Son, that is a ten-cent candy bar. I'm sorry, I can't sell it to you?' And the boy was disappointed by this news. But he thought and he thought and he thought and he came up with an idea. He said, "Why don't we compromise? I'll give you my nickel. We can take that candy bar, cut it in half, I'll have half, you have half for yourself. How 'bout that?"

And the man said to the little boy, "Son, that is a ten-cent candy bar. Get your skinny [butt] out of my store. Get yourself another nickel and I will sell it to you." And with that the man turned his back on the little boy.

And the little boy felt terribly rejected and cut off and abandoned. And he looked up at the man's broad back and he looked at the nickel in his hand and then he looked at the candy bar he wanted so much. And he reached out and touched the candy bar. And then he reached out and he held the candy bar. And then he ran out the store with the candy bar.

And as he was running down the street, he realized something: He still had his nickel in his hand! And in his other hand he had a whole candy bar! And he was suddenly filled with a tremendous feeling of happiness and joy and ecstasy.
Now let me ask you something: When was the last time you felt that good? I bet you can't even remember.

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You wanna know something? I feel that good every day. I feel that good every day because I am in touch with something deep inside of me. And I'm going to show you how to get in touch with the same thing deep inside of you.

You see, a few years ago I was in a very bad place in my life. Like most of you here tonight I was severely depressed, I was virtually suicidal. And I had to do some serious soul searching.

One day, I was searching around in my soul, and I heard a little voice behind me. It said: "Hi Phil, remember me?" And I turned around (I was in my soul of course), and there on the floor of my soul was a little tiny baby. I had discovered my inner baby within!

You see, I have a baby inside of me and that baby needs to be picked up. That baby needs to be coddled. That baby needs to have things go its own way once in awhile. It needs to cry. It needs to [pee] on people, it has to throw up on people. That's my inner baby within.

And the miracle is, every single one of us here has a little tiny inner baby inside of him or her. I don't care how old, or ugly, perverse or disturbed you might be, you were once a sweet, little, adorable, happy little baby. That baby is inside you right now.

That baby is talking to you, but you're not listening. Let's listen to our babies for a moment. Let's listen to my baby. What's my baby saying? "Mommy' Hear that? "Daddy" "Barney" My baby wants to get out, watch some TV!

Come on now, I want everybody to reach down and pick up his or her little baby. Go ahead, don't be afraid! Put your baby on your lap. And I want you to think about little babies.

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Ever watch a happy baby playing? They don't worry about tomorrow, they don't worry about yesterday. They don't worry about hurting other people's feelings. They don't worry about being responsible on the job or driving too fast or smoking too much. They don't read the newspaper, they don't watch the news, and they don't obey the law. Babies are in the NOW, they are connected to their centers.

Babies are rude, they are crude, they are selfish, and they are happy. And what do we do to these perfect little happy human beings? We take them and we make. them into adults, don't we? (Mimes building wall around the baby) We build a wall around our inner baby made of fear and anxiety and negativity and responsibility and hatred. Brick by brick. we build that wall: jealousy and guilt and ambition. Shame, lots of shame, let's get that shame up there. Brick by brick we wall them in around and around until our inner baby is trapped (Miming trapped) like a miniature Marcel Marceau!

I'm telling you to tear down that wall and let that baby out! Come on now and let your baby go! Get rid of that negativity. Stop worrying about tomorrow, stop worrying about yesterday! Stop worrying about what everybody else thinks about you all the time, what people think about you is none of your business! Stop worrying all the time. It's not helping anything! Sure there are people who are miserable all over the world, but hell. being all pissy and negative isn't going to do them much good. now is it? Sure the world is a complicated place, trying to understand it isn't going to make it any less complicated! Let me tell you something, the world has existed for twenty million years without your help, and it's gonna keep on going with or without you. Stop worrying about the whales and the elephants. They don't need you, your baby needs you!

I want you to take your baby's hand, go ahead, take it, it's not very big. And let that baby lead you to a new life of happiness, joy, and healthy selfishness!

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From this day onward you're gonna get up every morning and look into the mirror . . . you're gonna look into the mirror, you're gonna say to yourself: What. . . about. . . ME? When's it gonna be my turn? What about my baby?

You get in late for work. You're fifteen minutes late, the boss is pissed off. TOO BAD! My baby needed the sleep.

You forgot to send your Mom a Mother's Day card? She'll just have to wait till next year. Sorry, Mom. I'm busy being the mother you never were!

Driving around for half an hour trying to find someplace to park. Only parking spot is one of those handicapped parking spaces. You park there, your inner baby is handicapped!

It's midnight, you're watching Letterman on TV, halfway through that pint of Hagen Dasz, you finish it up, your baby needs that nurturing. Have another one! Chase it with a couple of Slim-Jims. Your baby needs your love!

You're gonna take care of your inner baby and this isn't going to be some part-time thing! You're going to be thinking about your inner baby incessantly. You're gonna be going to inner baby groups, talking to other inner babies on the phone. You're gonna buy videotapes, you're gonna buy my audiotapes, you're gonna read my books. I'm gonna sell you a little yellow sign, you put it in the window of your car, it's gonna say: "Caution, Inner Baby Within!"

You're gonna make your inner baby happy and when you do, you make yourself happy and when you're happy there will be one more happy person in the world. And you know what? You will have made the world a better place.

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SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Eric Bogosian
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AWARD HISTORY

2002 National Qualifier – Humorous Interp
2004 National Qualifier – Humorous Interp
S. Dakota State Finalist

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